ACTIVITY 1

Build a Risk-Based Internal Audit Programme

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K1 · A1 · LO1 · 75 minutes

Objective

Plan audit coverage that supports strategic priorities, compliance obligations and process risks.

Scenario

Meridian Precision Services (MPS) manufactures precision assemblies and provides field calibration. Customer complaints rose after a new supplier was introduced, two trained inspectors left, and a major customer added traceability requirements. The leadership team wants the internal audit programme to focus on risks that could affect conformity, delivery and customer confidence rather than repeating last year's calendar.

Materials

- Context and risk register in the Activity 1 workbook
- ISO 9001 clause map supplied in the course reference pack
- Organisation chart and process inventory in the activity PDF

Activity questions

- Which audit objectives best connect the programme to MPS strategic and quality priorities?
- Which processes should receive higher audit priority, and what evidence supports that priority?
- How will independence, competence, time and specialist support be managed?
- What programme measures will show whether the audit programme is effective?

Required evidence

- Completed programme workbook
- Risk-priority rationale
- Peer-review checklist
- Management briefing notes

Detailed Procedure

1. Read the MPS context, interested-party and risk information. Highlight facts that can affect QMS results; do not treat assumptions as evidence.

2. Define two or three audit programme objectives that describe the intended value of the programme, such as assurance over high-risk process controls and verification of corrective-action effectiveness.

3. List the core and support processes. Assign a risk priority using consequence, likelihood, recent change, previous findings and customer impact.

4. Select the processes to audit during the 12-month period. Explain why each is included and why any lower-risk process receives reduced coverage.

5. Set the proposed audit timing and frequency. Consider process sequence, peak workload, planned changes and availability of objective evidence.

6. Assign an audit team and confirm independence and competence. Record any technical expert or language/access support required.

7. Define programme-level resources, communication routes, records and escalation rules.

8. Choose at least three programme performance measures, including completion, timeliness, recurrence or stakeholder-value measures.

9. Peer-review another team's programme using the checklist. Challenge priorities that lack evidence or ignore major change.

10. Revise the programme and prepare a two-minute management justification for the final priorities.

Acceptance Check

Every planned audit traces to an objective and documented risk rationale; team independence and competence are explicit; no high-risk changed process is omitted without justification.

Learner completion checklist

Done	Evidence / output	Reviewer comment
■	Completed programme workbook	
■	Risk-priority rationale	
■	Peer-review checklist	
■	Management briefing notes	